

 Menu

Strategies for better results with prompt engineering

This [documentation from the Open AI platform](#)  discusses several strategies you can use to getting better results with your prompts.

It encourages experimentation with various methods and highlights that certain examples may only work with the most capable model. The strategies include writing clear instructions, incorporating details, asking the model to adopt a persona, using delimiters, specifying task steps, providing examples, indicating desired output length, and offering reference text. Additionally, it emphasizes the importance of decomposing complex tasks, allowing the model time to think before answering, and leveraging external tools. The guide suggests testing changes systematically and evaluating model outputs against gold-standard answers.

Critical Thinking questions

1. How might providing reference text enhance the reliability of responses from the language model, especially in the context of generating information on esoteric topics or including citations and URLs?
2. In what ways does breaking down complex tasks into simpler subtasks align with good practices in software engineering, and how might it contribute to improving the accuracy of language model outputs?
3. What are the trade-offs between asking the model for an instant response and instructing it to work out its own solution with time? How might this impact the model's reasoning abilities and overall reliability?

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